

7 Dictatorship and conflict in Russia, 1924-53

	• The leadership struggle, 1924-29 • Five-Year Plans and collectivisation • Purges and Moscow Show Trials • Cult of personality and the revision of history • The impact of the Second World War
	• The rivals for the leadership including Stalin, Trotsky, Kamenev, Bukharin and Zinoviev. Strengths and weaknesses of Stalin and Trotsky. Stalin's steps to power 1924-29. • Stalin's economic aims. Key features of industrialisation including Gosplan, the first three Five-Year Plans, Stakhanovites, living and working conditions. Reasons for and nature of mass collectivisation. Kolkhoz and Motor Tractor Stations. Opposition of and removal of kulaks. Success and failures of economic policies. Effects of policies on living and working conditions. The changing role of women. • Reasons for purges including the murder of Kirov. Key features of the purges of the 1930s. Yezhov, the NKVD and the gulags. Reasons for and features of Moscow Show Trials (1936-38). Purges of the armed forces. Impact of the purges on the Soviet Union. • Reasons for and methods of the cult of personality. Censorship, propaganda, 'socialist realism', control of education and the Soviet interpretation of history. • Early German success 1941-2, Stalingrad and reasons for the revival of the Soviet Union under Stalin. Stalin's popularity. Post-war purges, the Fourth Five-Year Plan and Stalin's death.